Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI role at Quillstone Payments. In my current data science work, I have built and evaluated machine learning workflows that inform operational decisions, including demand forecasting and weekly churn scoring. I am interested in bringing that applied experience to a team developing AI systems that help merchants get support quickly and without friction.

At Thistlebox, I developed a six-week demand forecast using LightGBM, with scheduled notebook outputs written to BigQuery and used by operations in Looker. Forecast WAPE improved from 23% to 14%, with an estimated 9% reduction in food waste. I also built a weekly XGBoost churn-scoring workflow in BigQuery; in a 10% holdout validation, churn was down 2.1 percentage points in the treated group. These projects have given me practical experience with feature engineering, model evaluation and data workflows used in ongoing business processes.

I have also built a Python Streamlit app for planning and analysing sequential A/B tests, now used by approximately 25 colleagues in product and growth. I wrote the app and its Dockerfile, while the data platform team handles its Cloud Run deployment. Since 2025, I have been writing pytest unit tests for forecasting feature code, reaching approximately 60% coverage. Alongside an MSc in Statistics and experience with Python, SQL and BigQuery, this has strengthened my interest in developing further as an ML engineer and contributing to the engineering practices that take ML systems into production.

Quillstone's focus on customer-support automation for merchants makes this role a compelling next step for me. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background in applied modelling, experimentation and data workflows could contribute to the AI team within Customer Operations.

Kind regards,

Tobias Mwangi-Hartley